
Lazara Ballester

"Communication leads to community."

— ROLLO MAY

Effective internal communication results in increased employee engagement, enhanced brand value, and better informed leaders.

My educational background in public relations, excellent communication skills, and expertise in both legacy and emerging technology have consistently led to successful outcomes.

Blog Posts
Microsoft Word & Word Processing
WordPress

Newsletters
Adobe Creative Suite
Email Marketing Software

Prospect Research
Database Management Software
LexisNexis

Presentations
Microsoft PowerPoint
Canva / Pitch / Prezi

ALL ABOUT

Aaron



Best Buddies Jobs and Whole Foods Market Make a Perfect Pairing

If you have ever shopped at Whole Foods Market in Pinecrest, Florida, chances are you have seen Aaron working hard behind the Prepared Foods counter. After ten years at the store, Aaron has helped countless customers looking for a tasty, hot meal. But don't worry if you haven't met him yet – Aaron intends to stick around for many years to come.

In 2003, Aaron was looking for a job. His dream job was to be a chef. Aaron completed a culinary arts program at a local vocational school, where he learned food preparation skills. Aaron enjoyed preparing food, and especially liked making breakfast at home. But what Aaron wanted most was to work somewhere that would let him do what he loves, which is being around food! That's when Aaron found Best Buddies Jobs. Aaron told his Employment Consultant what it is that he wanted to do, and his Employment Consultant set out to find Aaron his dream job.

In 2003, Aaron was looking for a job. His dream job was to be a chef. Aaron completed a culinary arts program at a local vocational school, where he learned food preparation skills. Aaron enjoyed preparing food, and especially liked making breakfast at home. But what Aaron wanted most was to work somewhere that would let him do what he loves, which is being around food! That's when Aaron found Best Buddies Jobs. Aaron told his Employment Consultant what it was that he wanted to do, and his Employment Consultant set out to find Aaron his dream job.

When Aaron's Employment Consultant heard that Wild Oats Natural Marketplace was hiring, they knew it was the right fit for Aaron. They helped Aaron get an interview, and before he knew it, Aaron was officially welcomed to the team! In just a few years, Wild Oats Natural Marketplace would become Whole Foods Market. Although lots of things within the store changed, one thing remained: Aaron's enthusiasm and love for his job. Not only was Aaron using his skills to as a Prepared Foods Team Member, he was learning new things every day.

Continued

By 2011, Aaron was in charge of cooking Whole Foods Market's famous rotisserie chicken. Aaron went in to work before the store opened and began preparing the daily flavor, seasoning and skewering each chicken before placing it in the rotisserie. Aaron soon learned that he had a special talent for preparing the rotisserie chicken. Word was spreading that the Pinecrest's location had the best rotisserie chicken, and before long, Pinecrest had the highest selling percentage of rotisserie chicken in the region!Aaron's chicken was so good, he was asked to train new team members on how to make the chicken so that others could learn his top-selling technique. "Aaron taught me everything about making the chicken," says Travis, a member of the Prepared Foods team. "That's why it's so good!"

This year, Aaron is celebrating his ten year anniversary with Whole Foods Market. Now instead of cooking the rotisserie chicken, Aaron works behind the scenes, preparing assorted vegetables and proteins for the many delicious dishes that Whole Foods Market serves on a daily basis. "I've been here ten years," says Aaron. "I've done it all."

Next time you are in Pinecrest and looking for a hot, ready to eat meal or snack, drop by Whole Foods Market. Chances are Aaron had something to do with just about anything you decide to pick up, whether it's a fresh-baked pizza, creamy macaroni and cheese, or tuna salad. If Aaron hasn't chopped, diced, or sliced it yet, he will soon. After all, he's just getting started.

Best Buddies Jobs continues the integration of people with developmental disabilities (IDD) into the community through supported employment. This program assists individuals to locate and maintain jobs of their own choosing by providing ongoing support and training. Our focus is on developing competitive, integrated jobs, which allow individuals to earn an income, pay taxes, and work in an environment alongside others in the community.

To learn more about the Best Buddies Jobs program in Florida, visit www.bestbuddiesflorida.org/jobs or contact Lazara Ballester at LazaraBallester@bestbuddies.org.

May 1, 2023 Volume 11

HOME BASE







Generation Next

BY LAZARA BALLESTER

On April 27, Resia took part in Take Your Child to Work Day with great success! Employees who participated were able to introduce their children to their colleagues and give them a glimpse into the world of real estate development and property management. The children enjoyed interactive activities, including learning about architecture, touring some of our rental communities, and even a building challenge.

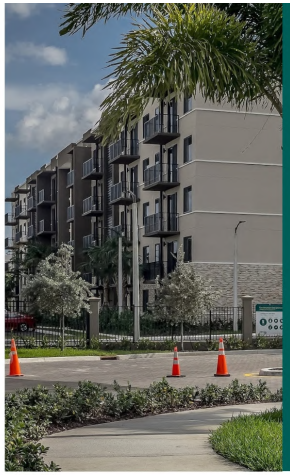
The event was a success thanks to the invaluable support of all the departments involved. We hope this event inspired the next generation of leaders and innovators and we look forward to continuing this tradition in the future.

Upcoming Events

Miami Corporate Run - April 27

Open Enrollment - June 1

Hands on Miami Day - June 6



We Value Your Experience

At Resia, we are committed to providing a positive work environment for all of our employees. In the coming weeks, we will be conducting our annual company climate survey where we gather feedback from employees, identify areas of improvement, and implement policies and procedures that better reflect the needs of everyone who works at Resia.

We encourage you to take the time to complete the survey honestly and thoroughly with the confidence of knowing that your responses will remain confidential. Your feedback will be used to inform our efforts to make our company an even better place to work. Thank you in advance for your participation.

New Initatives + Market Highlights

During May and June, we will be rolling out several new initiatives that will continue to keep Resia on the cutting-edge of the multi-family housing industry. Our new online portal offers our clients an intuitive and seamless experience renting properties.

Additionally, we now offer round-the-clock maintenance and repair support at all our properties. These upgrades guarantee that we will continue increasing demand for our luxury properties, with rental volumes on the rise.

To meet this demand, we are actively seeking to expand our reach and have identified several promising expansion markets.

We are proud to report that so far in 2023, Resia has achieved record-breaking figures, demonstrating the strength and resilience of the real estate market and our commitment to providing exceptional services to our clients.

LEONARD AND JAYNE

Abess



Giving Status

Recurring
(1995 - Present)

Contribution Level

$491,550
(2011 - 2017)

Philanthropic Interests

Arts & Humanities, Animal Welfare/Conservation, and Education

Contact

100 SE 32nd Rd, Miami, FL 33129
(305) 868-3600

Summary

Jayne H. (64) and Leonard L. Abess (70) are long-time supporters of the United Way of Miami-Dade. In 2011, Jayne was elected as board chair and currently continues her role as member emeritus on the executive committee. In 2018, Jayne and Leonard's daughter, Ashley Melisse, served as vice-chair of the Mayor's Ball. The Jayne and Leonard Abess Foundation has contributed $491,550 to the United Way of Miami-Dade since 2011, including $84,300 in 2017.

Philanthropic History

The Jayne and Leonard Abess Foundation was established in 2005, ten years after the couple joined United Way of Miami-Dade County's Million Dollar Roundtable. From 2015 through 2017, the foundation made $1,296,953 in contributions to 49 organizations. The contributions were divided amongst organizations supporting the arts and humanities, animal welfare, conservation, education, health, and social services.

Eighteen of the 49 organizations received contributions in at least two of the three years reported. Other notable contributions include a $5 million naming grant for the Abess Center for Ecosystem Science and Policy in 2006.

Cause	Amount Donated	Percentage of Total
Animal Welfare	$ 16,000	1%
Arts & Humanities	$ 54,700	4%
Conservation	$ 763,000	59%
Education	$ 126,250	10%
Health	$ 29,300	2%
Jewish Causes	$ 149,703	12%
Social Services	$ 153,800	12%
Other Foundations	$ 4,200	0.003%
United Way of Miami-Dade	**$ 114,300**	**9%**